Rebuttal to Argument Against Measure Z

Opponents want voters to see Measure Z as a tax on Benicia homeowners. It is not. **99% of existing Benicia homes are exempt.**

- Existing homes built before January 1, 2027 that sell for $2 million or less **are exempt from Measure Z.**
- So are specified family transfers and affordable housing.

Measure Z is designed primarily so new development, commercial property transactions, and higher-value property sales help pay for the services and infrastructure that growth requires.

That is simple fairness.

Benicia is entering a period of major change. New housing and redevelopment will require roads, police and fire protection, storm drains, parks, public facilities, and other City services.

Without Measure Z, **existing residents may end up bearing more of those costs.**

Measure Z is NOT an annual property tax. It applies only when taxable property is sold. The revenue stays in Benicia and **is subject to financial audits and citizen oversight.**

Opponents emphasize that Measure Z is a general-fund tax.

That means the money can support the basic, yet essential services Benicia's general fund pays for every day-including:

- Police
- Fire
- Streets and roads
- Infrastructure
- Other essential City services

The real question is whether **future development and higher-value property transactions** should contribute toward maintaining the community they benefit from.

Measure Z protects most existing homeowners while asking future development and higher-value transactions to pay a fair share.

That is a reasonable, fair and balanced approach for Benicia's future growth.

Please join us and vote YES on Measure Z.

/s/ Wendi S Phillips
/s/ Allison Costelow
/s/ Terence Bennett
/s/ Stephen Young

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